

ZINGISA NOZUKO MOTLOBA

Attorney | Infrastructure and Energy Advisor | ESG & Leadership Strategist

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

A Pan-African strategist with a legal background. Passionate about sustainability that is rooted in unlocking investment in economic infrastructure that catalyses growth and prosperity across African markets. A senior attorney and ESG strategy consultant with over 24 years' experience across energy regulation, project finance, corporate M&A, ESG strategy and governance.

Admitted as an attorney in 2002, with a distinguished career in Project Finance, Private Equity M&A Thought leader and advisor in ESG, sustainability, culture and inclusion.

CORE COMPETENCIES

✦ Economic Infrastructure	✦ People & Leadership
✦ ESG & Sustainability	✦ Culture & DEI
✦ Corporate Governance	✦ Commercial Legal

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Director | Athari Consulting | August 2025 – Present

Providing sustainability, governance and ESG impact strategy advisory services across sectors and regions

- Business & Economic development strategy consulting
- ESG risk management, and sustainability reporting obligations.
- Leadership & Governance.

Partner | Bowmans | October 2023 – July 2025

Corporate M&A and private equity practice. Provided strategic and transaction advisory, deal structuring, contract negotiation and drafting, deal preparation and due diligence services to private equity impact fund clients.

- Deal structuring and legal due diligence on M&A and private equity transactions across various sectors.
- Negotiated and drafted various transaction agreements including shareholders agreements, sale and purchase agreements, and term sheets.
- Advised on corporate governance and ESG trends and frameworks.
- Delivered leadership and career development workshops for the candidate attorneys.

Founder & Director | Alchemy Africa | September 2019 – 2023

ESG risk management consulting and advisory firm providing pre-investment due diligence, monitoring, evaluation and reporting of ESG initiatives, and Board/Exco ESG training.

- Served as Senior Strategy Advisor to the Executive Office of Economic Development and Strategy at NEOM, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia — advising on mega infrastructure project development and ESG strategy.
- Provided ESG due-diligence services to private equity firms.
- Provided sustainability reporting services.
- Delivered DEI and Culture assessments, facilitated workshops, guided training, policy reviews and strategy alignment for various local and international clients.
- Delivered training to South African National Energy Association (SANEA) members on ESG in the context of the Just Energy Transition (JET) (2021 & 2022).

- Panelist: ESG Africa Conference 2022;
- Advisory Board Member: African Women in Energy and Power;
- Regional Member, IUCN International Standards Committee on Nature Based Solutions.

Executive: Standards Development | South African Bureau of Standards (SABS) | September 2017 – July 2019

Provided strategic and financial oversight over a division of 95+ people with a budget of R54.4 million. Responsible for the development of South African National Standards (SANS) and regulatory guidance across key industries.

- Developed and implemented divisional strategy aligned to the SABS Corporate Plan.
- Maintained South Africa's WTO National Enquiry Point on Technical Barriers to Trade.
- Represented South Africa on trade policy matters at WTO, ISO, IEC, ARSO, SADCSTAN, AFREC and AFSEC.
- Improved fiscal discipline against performance. Improved stakeholder relationships in industry, as well as with regional and international standards bodies.
- Chairperson: SABS Tender Committee.
- Non-Executive Director: Business and Arts South Africa (NPC); Board Chairperson (2021-2025)

Senior Manager: Legal & Compliance | Eskom | July 2013 – August 2017

Led a team of 6 legal professionals and 3 support staff responsible for regulation, legal and compliance across Eskom's operating divisions — including Transmission, Distribution, Customer Services and Enterprise Risk. Other non-core divisions supported included Eskom Telecoms and Eskom Aviation. Also provided advisory oversight to the Exco Procurement Committee (≥R30million≤R75million).

- Lead legal representative at the Southern Africa Power Pool (SAPP), and the AU Association of Power Utilities in Africa (APUA). Established the Legal Working Group at SAPP
- Lead advisor to the Grid Access Unit on the Renewable Energy Independent Power Producer Procurement Programme (REIPPP) — including the negotiation and review of Power Purchase Agreements (PPAs) and related project agreements between IPPs and Eskom as off taker.
- Provided strategic transaction and regulatory advice on cross-border transmission and generation projects as lead advisor to the Southern Africa Energy division.
- Supported SAE in the setting up of the PMO to manage and seek private funding for all cross-border projects.
- Managed key relationships with NERSA (Tariffs, Operating Licences, Grid Code, IPPs, Cross-border operations, load-shedding), ICASA and the Civil Aviation Authority.
- Managed legal panel relationships, external spend and fiscal prudence across multiple law firms.
- Named Executive of the Year: Office of the CEO (2016);
- Listed on Legal 500 GC500 Africa Teams (2017).

General Counsel & Company Secretary | Mercedes-Benz South Africa | February 2012 – June 2013

Managed a legal and secretariat function across all divisions with an annual budget of R10 million, covering Treasury, Passenger and Commercial Vehicles, After-Sales, the East London production facility and group procurement.

- Set up and led the legal department aligned to Head Office policy framework and local operational requirements.
- Provided compliance direction on Competition law, Intellectual Property, Consumer Liability, Labour Relations, Money-laundering, and JSE Listings requirements (MBSA had a listed Bond).
- Served as Exco and Board Company Secretary, ensuring governance, ethics and regulatory compliance.
- Managed subsidiary entities: Mercedes-Benz Financial Services, Daimler Fleet Management, Atlantis Foundries and Sandown Motor Holdings.

Senior Manager: Legal & Compliance, Company Secretary | Blue IQ Investment Holdings | March 2007 – January 2012

Regulatory, legal and compliance management for major Gauteng infrastructure projects including the Newtown revitalisation project, automotive sector investment initiatives and landmark public infrastructure.

- Active management of Blue IQ-initiated projects including the Mandela Bridge, the Constitutional Court precinct, the Innovation Hub, Newtown regeneration, and the OR Tambo International Airport Industrial

Development Zone — providing legal structuring, contract negotiation and risk management experience and project delivery contracting.

- Designed and implemented robust compliance and risk management frameworks.
- Led the R40 million automotive SME incubator in Silverton in partnership with Ford Motor Company as project lead.
- Part of the leadership team that delivered Blue IQ's first-ever unqualified audit.

Associate / Senior Associate | Webber Wentzel Attorneys | October 2003 – February 2007

Started in the Private Equity M&A team. Seconded to Linklaters London. Returned to join the Project Finance and Infrastructure team.

- PE fund establishment, pre investment due diligence, shareholder agreements, share purchase agreements, sale of business agreements, and other commercial agreements and governance services.
- Project finance legal work on landmark South African PPP transactions: Refinancing of MozGas, Department of Education Head office, Department Trade and Industry Head office; N3 Toll Concession, the Gautrain Rapid Rail Link, and the Bakwena Platinum Corridor Toll Plaza — involving end-to-end project finance documentation structuring directly analogous to renewable energy project finance and construction contracts.
- Gained foundational project finance documentation experience: credit agreements, security packages, direct agreements and lender due diligence.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2023: Global Reporting Initiative (GRI): Introduction to Sustainability Reporting

2019: Trade & Industrial Policy Strategies - Industrial Policy for Policy Makers

2013: UCT GSB — Managing Power Sector Reform and Regulation in Africa

2012: GIBS — Women in Leadership

2007–2008: GIBS — MBA (Research: Socially Responsible Investing in Private Equity)

1999: Wits Business School — Management Advancement Programme

1995–1998: University of South Africa — LLB

1992–1994: UKZN (Pietermaritzburg) — BA (Law and English)

BOARD & LEADERSHIP ROLES

- Board Chairperson — Business and Arts South Africa (NPC)
- Advisory Board Member — African Women in Energy and Power
- Regional Member — IUCN International Standards Committee on Nature Based Solutions
- Mentor — Aspire Foundation UK

RECOGNITION, THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- Legal 500 GC500: Africa Teams (2017)
- Executive of the Year: Office of the CEO (2016)
- Keynote address — 5th Annual Global Risk Symposium on Risk, Resilience and Leadership (2019)
- Moderator — SADC Centre for Renewable Energy & Energy Efficiency (SACREEE) Industrial Energy Efficiency Conference (2019)
- Panelist — ESG Africa Conference 2022
- Trainer — SANEA Members: ESG in the Just Energy Transition (2021 & 2022)
- https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/cop30-putting-people-governance-resilient-heart-climate-motloba-qyycf?utm_source=share&utm_medium=member_android&utm_campaign=share_via
- [Africa needs to be proactive in defining an apt response to the 'new normal' \(businesslive.co.za\)](https://businesslive.co.za)
- <http://www.ee.co.za/article/how-the-convergence-of-standards-on-goods-and-services-can-help-promote-intra-african-trade.html>